

Speaker 1 [00:00:01] I should have started our registration. Can you first confirm that you have read the consent form and that you are voluntarily participating in the study?

Speaker 2 [00:00:10] I confirm, okay.

Speaker 1 [00:00:12] Fantastic, thank you. Can I take notes during our conversation?

Speaker 2 [00:00:17] You can.

Speaker 1 [00:00:20] I'm going to start with some small talk first, some questions, and then I'll have some questions about what makes a good relationship and your current relationship, if that's okay with you. You may not answer any questions you want. You can end this interview at any time. It is completely voluntary. How old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:00:41] [56-60].

Speaker 1 [00:00:45] How long have you been with your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:00:49] We're close to [26-30]. [26-30].

Speaker 1 [00:00:53] Do you have children?

Speaker 2 [00:00:55] We have [1-5].

Speaker 1 [00:00:59] Who do you live with at home?

Speaker 2 [00:01:02] Just with my husband right now. My [child], well, she is usually at school.

Speaker 1 [00:01:08] What is your main source of income, how do you make a living?

Speaker 2 [00:01:10] We are both retired.

Speaker 1 [00:01:16] I call your partner as your spouse but is it appropriate for you?

Speaker 2 [00:01:21] Uh-huh.

Speaker 1 [00:01:24] Would you like to tell me a little bit about how you met, how did you meet, how did your relationship start?

Speaker 2 [00:01:32] We met through a friend in [City]. He had come to [City] for his job, to work. I was also in [City], we had mutual friends. We met through our mutual friends. After that we liked each other. I pushed her a little bit, probably because of her age. Because she was young. She was [20-25] years old. She was a bit shy. Not shy as a character, I mean there was shyness in terms of the situation. But well, I guess we built a mutual trust. After that, our friendship progressed and in a short period of time, I think it wasn't even [1-5] from friendship, from meeting to marriage. I sound clear, don't I?

Speaker 1 [00:02:36] It's very clear, so is your image. Is mine clear too?

Speaker 2 [00:02:38] Uh-huh.

Speaker 1 [00:02:41] How did you build trust with each other? How did your journey go from meeting to marriage within a year?

Speaker 2 [00:02:53] I mean, probably being straightforward. It's actually not that difficult for people to get to know each other. It's a little bit, being straightforward, fulfilling what is promised. I don't know, I guess our communication in that process established a mutual trust between us. The fact that there was liking, of course, contributed to the progress of the process.

Speaker 1 [00:03:28] What do you mean by liking?

Speaker 2 [00:03:31] Let's say the joy and happiness of spending time together.

Speaker 1 [00:03:39] How would you rate your own relationship quality compared to the relationships of people around you, your friends?

Speaker 2 [00:03:52] When I say environment, now there are two environments. There is the [City] environment, and now we are still in the summer house. We have been here for a long time. When we look at the environment here, we are quite high up. When we look at the [City] environment, I can say that we are probably above average. So we are not worse, we can be better. The predominant factor here is me.

Speaker 1 [00:04:31] What does that mean?

Speaker 2 [00:04:32] More... I mean, [Partner's Name] is much more giving in my opinion. She is like [Partner's Name]. I mean, she can simplify things much more but my character is a bit different from [Partner's Name]'s. I'm a bit more meticulous, I have my own characteristics, I'm a bit of a difficult person to be honest. So when I criticize, I'm actually criticizing myself rather than criticizing the relationship. I mean, I can be better. We are above average, as I said before. The reason why we are not at the top is because of me, not [Partner's Name].

Speaker 1 [00:05:28] Okay. What did you take into consideration and give such an answer?

Speaker 2 [00:05:34] I visualized the profiles of the people around me and of course, what appears to be and what is in reality is never the same, you know. We may appear to be a very, very perfect couple on the outside, but inside of course we have painful moments. Managing them, not reflecting them outside. I mean not reflecting them to the outside; I mean solving them within ourselves, not in the sense of hiding, but solving them within ourselves. In other words, if we have a resentment, not to prolong it too long, to resolve the argument between us in a shorter time. But unfortunately I am the cause of most of these arguments (smiles). And I am also aware of that.

Speaker 1 [00:06:22] What kind of arguments do you have? Let's skip there, since it's been brought up.

Speaker 2 [00:06:29] I mean, it's usually simple things. I mean, it's more like, I guess, the protection of personal freedom creates a bit of a problem for me. I mean, I have a bit more of a desire to keep my own space reserved for me, sometimes not always, of course, there is a desire to stay within my own freedom zone at certain times. When I think that this desire is sometimes not met, it can cause me trouble. And this can be an excuse for me to create a reason for discussion.

Speaker 1 [00:07:20] How often would you say you argue?

Speaker 2 [00:07:26] I mean, probably once a week at most. Once a week. When I say arguing, I don't mean a fight, I mean a small duel of words.

Speaker 1 [00:07:40] On such a day or something like that?

Speaker 2 [00:07:41] I mean an event of three to five minutes. I mean, when I say discussion, I don't mean something that leads to a big fight. Which also needs to happen. I mean, this is what is needed for a healthy relationship to take place. We still know each other, as a matter of fact. I mean, [30-35] years have passed, but we still continue to recognize each other's different characteristics. That's why sometimes I wonder if we got married in a short time, [6-10] months, [6-10] months. I mean, what difference would it have made if it had been [30-35] years? If we still haven't gotten to know each other this much in [30-35] years, then we would still be discovering something new after [30-35] years. So I don't find it strange that we got married in [1-5] years.

Speaker 1 [00:08:31] Do your arguments ever turn into fights? I mean, from a duel of words, raising voices at some point or something like that.

Speaker 2 [00:08:40] No, we don't have such an intense argument. Very rare, sometimes. So let's call it [1-5 times] a year if there is such a thing.

Speaker 1 [00:08:54] Do you ever argue about other issues, except for the restriction of freedom?

Speaker 2 [00:09:05] No, I mean space of freedom is a general term here. I don't know, there is a place where I put the plates, it is a habit for me. Changing its place means that my space is touched. I'm talking about these kinds of things, when I say space of freedom. I don't want to give the wrong impression, I'm not talking about a space of freedom in the sense of leave me alone. I mean, let's say such simple reasons.

Speaker 1 [00:09:40] Like daily habits?

Speaker 2 [00:09:42] Yes, yes yes. I mean, it's not a problem if my habits are broken but it's a problem when [Partner's Name]'s habits are broken. I mean, well (smiles)... That's why it's because of me, that's what I meant by that. I mean she's not bothered, I'm bothered by such small things. That's what I was blaming myself for. She can take such things quite naturally.

Speaker 1 [00:10:13] How do you resolve your arguments?

Speaker 2 [00:10:19] Sometimes I find myself wrong, I think I exaggerate; after a certain point. And sometimes [Partner's Name] is the opposite: 'Yes, I shouldn't have changed it. Right, you are right. That's where it should have been practical. You also had such a habit. So that's how the thing gets resolved.

Speaker 1 [00:10:38] To ask if I got it right; by being self-critical and continuing the conversation?

Speaker 2 [00:10:42] Yes, exactly.

Speaker 1 [00:10:50] Okay, we can go back. We left off last time when you had a better relationship than your friends.

Speaker 2 [00:10:58] No, I would say we are above average. I would also say that we are not perfect. I also accept that I am the obstacle on the way to perfection.

Speaker 1 [00:11:13] How many romantic relationships have you had in the past, may I ask?

Speaker 2 [00:11:18] [1-5]. But neither of them lasted this long. One of them was interrupted because I went to a different place for education. That interruption became permanent. The other one I had in the place I went to. It was also interrupted by my return (laughs), and that ended there.

Speaker 1 [00:11:41] It ended when you were changing places.

Speaker 2 [00:11:42] Yes, yes yes.

Speaker 1 [00:11:44] How long was your previous relationship... (They spoke at the same time.)

Speaker 2 [00:11:44] I was overseas...

Speaker 1 [00:11:47] Heh, sorry. Here you go.

Speaker 2 [00:11:49] I went abroad, I came back from abroad. I mean, the places I went were different. How long did it last? One for [1-5] months, let's say [1-5] months. The other one, [6-10] months. But I mean, there was more of a liking than a love there. Well, we didn't have anything like turning it into a deep relationship process anyway. I mean it was a friendship, I mean it was a relationship beyond friendship.

Speaker 1 [00:12:27] How would you rate the quality of your current relationship compared to your previous relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:12:33] Well, of course these two are not comparable. So it's not something that can be compared. In the other one it's something, making a friend out of a natural need, here it's sharing life. So they are two very different things, so they are not two things to compare.

Speaker 1 [00:12:55] What makes a relationship high quality, qualified, good for you?

Speaker 2 [00:13:05] I think the first one is trust. The second thing is, I mean, I will call it love (aşk), but there is also love (sevgi), there is also communication, there is also friendship, there is also goodwill, there is also mutual understanding. So when you look at my definition of love, you can put this and more in it. So it's not just liking someone, loving someone, it's underpinning this with trust, proper communication and making it liveable, feeding it with love, the need for protection. So many factors; sharing is of course a must. I mean, if it is a slice of bread, there is also the feeling of the beauty of being able to cut it in half and eat it.

Speaker 1 [00:14:04] What do you think makes a relationship low quality?

Speaker 2 [00:14:10] First of all, I think it is the loss of trust, number one. I mean, I'm going to call it a lie, but I mean, maybe it's heavy. The fact that it makes a communication that is not true. Even

with good intentions. Even with good intentions, I think communication that will damage trust is the number one factor.

Speaker 1 [00:14:38] Are there other factors?

Speaker 2 [00:14:42] I mean, of course, I don't need to talk about love, these are already things; that is, if you don't like someone, if you don't look at someone with a little intense feeling of love, if you suppress it, you are trying to keep a relationship that is already over inside you. From our point of view, I mean from my point of view, I shouldn't say our point of view, it's a wrong term. So from my point of view, it's the opposite. So love and intimacy and...and respect.

Speaker 1 [00:15:27] So in a sense can we say that what makes a relationship good is trust and love; trust, love and open communication?

Speaker 2 [00:15:41] I mean if the order is not important, yes, I mean the order may change. So love can also be trust. Trust can also be love. I mean, well, in no particular order, yes. Definitely yes.

Speaker 1 [00:15:58] Okay. So what are the most important things in a relationship for you?

Speaker 2 [00:16:08] I mean, I think the beauty of sharing is number one. I mean it doesn't matter what you share. If you are happy to share, if you enjoy it, I think it makes the relationship beautiful.

Speaker 1 [00:16:30] I was going to ask what to share, but sharing everything as I understand it.

Speaker 2 [00:16:34] Sharing everything, yes. That's why I gave the example of bread. I mean, it could be sharing a vacation. It can also be sharing the excitement you get from a movie when you watch a movie. I mean, they all come back to you, to me, as a happiness, a pleasure on a different scale. Let me not speak as you, let me not generalize, let me say myself.

Speaker 1 [00:17:00] Hmm. How would you define sharing? What is it like to share?

Speaker 2 [00:17:04] Sharing is something internal, for me. I mean, I'm not talking about the item you share, I'm talking about the pleasure you get when you share that item. I mean, I'm talking

about the happiness it gives. I gave the example of the movie. I think internalizing the bad character of the bad guy while watching the movie, internalizing the good characteristics of the good woman or the good guy is also a good example of sharing. Or let me go to a more concrete example. Sharing a good meal I made and saying that it was good is also a very good example of sharing.

Speaker 1 [00:17:47] I mean, you seem to be describing not just sharing the experience but something indefinable, something difficult to define. You seem to be describing a counterpart in the inner world.

Speaker 2 [00:17:55] Yes, yes. There is also a physical sharing, of course, it has to happen before that, but I am in the result. I mean, the pleasure I get as a result is more for me. Otherwise, uh, I don't know, sharing a bagel by cutting it in half is of course a concrete thing, but the happiness I get when I share it, uh, that's what I actually want to emphasize.

Speaker 1 [00:18:24] If I ask you what makes you happy, for example?

Speaker 2 [00:18:27] The happiness I get from mutual, reciprocal pleasure, knowing that she is getting pleasure. And most probably her happiness because I'm getting pleasure. I mean, I think it's actually the thought that we make each other happy. I mean, I've never thought about it before (laughs) I'm trying to imagine it now that you asked me.

Speaker 1 [00:18:52] That's quite enough. Well, that's the point anyway. Thinking together right now in a sense. Is there anything else? Apart from sharing and the pleasure of making each other happy, what do you consider to be the most important factors of the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:19:06] Well, there is something. Now some things that make her happy, that make her very happy may not be so important for me. Likewise, the things that make me very happy, uh... Here also self-sacrifice comes into play. Tolerating the things that make her very happy, being open to them, supporting them are actually for the good development of this relationship and again, there is actually sharing here. In a sense, I share her happiness or she shares my happiness. To ensure the development of this. Here is an example. I... Being with her siblings and nieces and nephews is an event that makes [Partner's Name] very happy; if they stay with us for a month, two months, whatever, I... ha ha, I would be very happy too, but not for [1-5] months. Don't let [Partner's Name] hear everything (laughs), but I would also be happy if she was happy. I would never make it an inconvenience.



Speaker 1 [00:20:16] Being able to put your own preferences in the second plan for the satisfaction of the other party.

Speaker 2 [00:20:22] Yes, yes yes. So you described it right, right.

Speaker 1 [00:20:26] Dedication.

Speaker 2 [00:20:27] Dedication.

Speaker 1 [00:20:27] So that's how you define selflessness?

Speaker 2 [00:20:29] Yes, yes.

Speaker 1 [00:20:31] Is there a third thing? Sharing, uh, prioritizing the satisfaction of the other person...

Speaker 2 [00:20:40] Uh...it is also very important to have a common opinion on some issues. I mean, I don't know. Uh... I don't want [Partner's Name] to wear a turban. She doesn't wear a turban either. I don't know... I don't want [Partner's Name] to vote for the [Political Party]. She doesn't vote for [Political Party] either. I mean, call it the social dimension, call it the political dimension, call it the flow of life, the view of life, it's similar. I don't want to say the same, but being in parallel thinking, that is, a similar lifestyle, a similar lifestyle is also a very important factor, of course.

Speaker 1 [00:21:22] Let me ask you again since it keeps coming up, is there a fourth thing?

Speaker 2 [00:21:27] There will definitely be, but there is not at the moment, it is not coming now.

Speaker 1 [00:21:31] Okay. We just touched on how to define love. What is love (aşk) according to you?

Speaker 2 [00:21:41] Love (aşk) is caring for the person, caring about the person, beyond love (sevgi), of course. Uh... The need to take on the pain, sadness that may come to a person and to

alleviate it from him/her, to reduce the pain that will come to him/her, to alleviate it, to protect him/her. I mean, it's mutual, I mean, I'm not talking about a gender protection here. I... (Unintelligible) I guess I can describe it as a totality of love (sevgi).

Speaker 1 [00:22:27] How important is love for a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:22:34] It's very important according to this definition. So it's not just liking someone, loving (sevmek) someone. With the characteristics I said, that's how I define love. I'm doing this definition right now, uh, it's definitely important.

Speaker 1 [00:22:52] What distinguishes love (sevgi) from affection?

Speaker 2 [00:22:54] Excuse me?

Speaker 1 [00:22:54] What distinguishes it from love?

Speaker 2 [00:22:58] Love (sevgi)... Uh... I can define it as the addition of the characteristics of caring, making sacrifices such as preventing the pain, suffering that will come to him and taking it upon oneself, which I have just said, to love. When I say love (sevgi), the concepts of loving someone, liking someone, enjoying spending time with them are on the one hand, but when I define love (aşk), I define it as making sacrifices by eliminating everything that could negatively affect them, being in a position to make sacrifices, as I have just defined.

Speaker 1 [00:23:52] So, how do you know if your partner loves you? How to understand that the other one loves you, loves someone?

Speaker 2 [00:23:58] Generally, a look is enough. There is no need for any speech. I mean, before the sentences come out of the tongue, before they come out of the mouth, his/her expression, his/her gestures, his/her hand gestures already define that love. So I can say communication. I mean love (sevgi) through communication alone. So I can answer your question.

Speaker 1 [00:24:32] What kind of look, what kind of expression?

Speaker 2 [00:24:35] Soft...

Speaker 1 [00:24:36] How do we understand it?

Speaker 2 [00:24:39] I mean her sincerity, warmth, inclusiveness when she speaks. I mean, even if the words she uses tell something negative, even if she tells something negative, the love letters come out in it. So I can catch it in the air, for myself.

Speaker 1 [00:25:02] Hmm.

Speaker 2 [00:25:05] I mean, no matter what the subject is, during that communication, I also take the other person's emotion into the communication. So we can speak with emotion. To be able to capture that emotion is actually what I'm trying to say. I don't know if I've made myself clear, well...

Speaker 1 [00:25:22] Well, I understand, do I understand correctly? ... You say that there is something you feel inside you, even though we are not very sure what it is objectively. I mean, I don't know what his face is, what his look is, it's not very clear there, but it's like you are saying that something has passed to you.

Speaker 2 [00:25:42] Yes yes, electricity yes. I mean you get electricity, I mean you get warm electricity, it doesn't hit you, on the contrary, you want that electricity to come more towards you. Well, of course you get it in communication. The subject of communication is not important.

Speaker 1 [00:26:05] Would you say that this relationship you are in is good for you?

Speaker 2 [00:26:10] I would say absolutely. I mean... I mean, despite my own faults and flaws, I can say that this relationship makes me happy. I mean, I feel and experience the happiness of being in such a relationship. I mean, I'm happy to be in such a situation. I'm happy to be married to [Partner's Name], that's what I mean. I'm happy to live with [Partner's Name]. I'm happy to wake up together, have breakfast together. I'm happy to say good night even if she goes to bed early. I usually go to bed late (laughs).

Speaker 1 [00:27:00] What makes you happy? Being happy is like a state, is there anything that feels good?

Speaker 2 [00:27:08] Uh, actually, it's probably electricity. I mean, when I am in the same environment with her, it makes me feel good. So she doesn't have to do anything to make me feel that way. I can think of it as life doping, I can say that. [Partner's Name] doesn't hear it, right? (laughs) No, she's not here...

Speaker 1 [00:27:37] I don't know that either.(laughs)

Speaker 2 [00:27:39] (Continues laughing) Things that I didn't express because. The video is not going to be released, is it?

Speaker 1 [00:27:46] No. The video will not be released.

Speaker 2 [00:27:48] But he will read the transcript (laughs).

Speaker 1 [00:27:51] Well, if you are okay with it, yes he can read it.

Speaker 2 [00:27:56] Let him read it dear.

Speaker 1 [00:27:58] Uh, okay. So am I understanding it right? Again... Since being happy is a difficult thing to define, it sounds like it makes me happy to be alive, to exist. Of course, when I say life doping, I understand it as energizing.

Speaker 2 [00:28:23] No, not energizing. I mean, after all, I mean, we are alive, but we have a goal right now, I mean, when you look at our age, we are [56-60] years old. We are now in a period where our goals are limited. I mean, in the past I had a career goal, I don't know, I had a goal to make money. Those are no longer in our minds. We are not setting a new goal for ourselves to exist in life right now. We are just maintaining the life process, we are continuing it, but in order to continue it happily, we need to improve our conditions, when I think of a life without [Partner's Name]. And what is improving the conditions? You get a social circle. When you say social circle, there are people you are happy with, there are people you are unhappy with. You leave, you start to experience tides, but I don't need a goal to live with [Partner's Name] right now. I enjoy living with her, I enjoy being in life. I don't know how you define happiness, but I enjoy being in life... I couldn't finish the sentence.

Speaker 1 [00:29:51] Hmm. Has this relationship changed you?

Speaker 2 [00:29:56] The relationship changed me?

Speaker 1 [00:29:57] Did it change you? If so, how did it change you?

Speaker 2 [00:30:01] I mean it changed some, some things of course. I mean, uh... I mean, it softened my rigid features. I mean, I guess the other way around is not acceptable anyway. I mean, the fact that people continue to have the characteristics they had [30-35] or [36-40] years ago and those characteristics [36-40] years later is already something to be denied. I've been sculpted, I mean, in the process of the relationship, but a perfect sculpture has not yet emerged, but the sculpture has taken a shape, it has become a little beautiful. So he sculpted me (Guler).

Speaker 1 [00:30:46] What do you mean by softening, your rigid features? I mean a little more...

Speaker 2 [00:30:52] I mean himself.

Speaker 1 [00:30:54] Here you go.

Speaker 2 [00:30:55] I had my own boundaries, I'll call it redrawing my boundaries. I mean, I won't say redrawing my boundaries. I mean those boundaries were unnecessary boundaries. I mean, they were unacceptable boundaries in coexistence. I can't give a concrete example, I mean, well... I had to stretch those boundaries, I had to stretch them, this thing, in order to make the relationship healthier, better. Of course, I won't call it a sacrifice, it was something that had to be done anyway. We come from different living spaces, we come from different social environments, we were raised by different families, we have different learnings. In order for these learnings of ours to meet at a common point, I, [Partner's Name], too, but I think I have more of it, in myself. We had to evolve ourselves in the process of transition to a common life. So I think we did that evolution. Did we complete it? For me, I didn't complete it, but well, since [Partner's Name] was much more flexible in this regard, [Partner's Name] completed that evolution very quickly. I am trying to complete it to a great extent.

Speaker 1 [00:32:24] How do you think she changed?

Speaker 2 [00:32:26] Sorry?

Speaker 1 [00:32:27] How did she change? Has he changed?

Speaker 2 [00:32:29] He? She...uh, she changed of course. I mean... I shouldn't say she's more sensitive, I should say she's more adaptive. I mean, it's about mutual adaptation. Now, if you think about the story of the plate being moved, like the example I gave at the beginning, maybe it was not important for her. I mean, you can look at it as what's wrong with it, but since she thought that I cared about it, she perceived not moving it as a need for coexistence. Or that it was important for me, it may not be important for her, but it is a change for her. When you look at it from this point of view, not moving the plate. Or, I don't know, if I left my wallet somewhere, it needs to be moved. Let me pick it up from where I left it so that it's a practical thing, it's practical for me. I shouldn't look for it. Or when we get up in the morning, there is a place I look, I take 2-3 items from there, and leave. If that item is not there, I might forget it. If she used to change it for the sake of being organized, she changed herself with the thought that 'being organized is not that important, if this is more useful for [Name], I shouldn't change it'.

Speaker 1 [00:34:12] Her own habits... Am I understanding correctly, I am explaining it again and again. In a sense, she structured her own habits by taking your habits into consideration.

Speaker 2 [00:34:22] Exactly. That's right.

[00:34:22] Exactly. But it's mutual. Now, I mean, on my side, I'm already...

Speaker 1 [00:34:28] You have already asked for it.

Speaker 2 [00:34:29] Well, sure, sure. Yes, yes, yes.

Speaker 2 [00:34:29] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:00:29] Yeah. Changing our habits mutually, that's the definition, yes.

Speaker 1 [00:34:38] Do you feel safe in the relationship, in this relationship that you are in?

Speaker 2 [00:34:44] Of course I do, yes.

Speaker 1 [00:34:47] Would you like to expand a little bit more?

Speaker 2 [00:34:49] I mean... I mean, I think our mutual communication is good and I know that our arguments are very - I mean, those arguments once a week, once a month - are due to very simple reasons and I know that they are solved instantly in a very short time, spontaneously. But when you look at it as a percentage, when I think that 95% - 98% of the time I enjoy being together and 2% of the things can be resolved instantly, yes, I feel very safe. In terms of the relationship, I think that a mutual trust environment has been established.

Speaker 2 [00:35:54] Are you going to cross-compare? [Partner's Name]'s answers, [Participant's] answers.

Speaker 1 [00:36:03] I will not.

Speaker 2 [00:36:04] These are the analyzes...

Speaker 1 [00:36:07] I don't know what they do, believe me. Because they are in words, because they are not clear. There is something called thematic analysis. Thematic will be put into thematic analysis in a sense. I don't know how they are going to measure whether the couples are saying similar things or not, but I know that they are going to do a thematic analysis. It is a research to discover what the more important issues are. So 'what is repeating', actually. You know, not just your compatibility with each other, not just whether you say similar things or not, but what couples say, what they say. It's a research that investigates what humanity as a group says, what we call quality. So I don't know.

Speaker 2 [00:36:55] It's also principled.

Speaker 1 [00:36:57] Harmonized... We have the part for [Country], we also have it in other countries. Exactly, they are trying to develop something universal.

Speaker 2 [00:37:04] There will probably be something like a comparison of the relationship between countries. Relationship...

Speaker 1 [00:37:09] Probably. I guess it might. So if I were to ask a question about trust, how do you think it feels to feel safe?

Speaker 2 [00:37:24] Well it's a comforting thing first of all. I mean when you turn around, you're sure that there's an environment that you don't have any doubts. So knowing that there's not going to be a situation that makes you uncomfortable is the most important thing. Uh, or uh, we have certain common habits. Commonly developed habits and living these habits is also an element of trust. The common habits we form together give you confidence. It could be a walk on the beach, it could be eating a meal together, it could be having breakfast together or liking x cheese for breakfast, liking it together is actually a trust. I mean, you're not taking the risk of eating y cheese after all.

Speaker 1 [00:38:29] A predictability, predictability. Then I need to share something with you, a...

Speaker 2 [00:38:41] Doesn't [Partner's Name] like that cheese? (laughs)

Speaker 1 [00:38:44] No, I don't know that. I don't even know which cheese it is, believe me.

Speaker 2 [00:38:48] [Brand]. (Laughs.)

Speaker 1 [00:38:50] [Brand]. Wait, where is it ... Oh, it's closed. Share. Well, if I asked you, 'My partner usually really listens to me,' what would you answer, with 1 being not true at all and 9 being completely true?

Speaker 2 [00:39:24] 'My partner usually really listens to me. 9. Not 8, 9 yes.

Speaker 1 [00:39:35] Why 9 and not 8?

Speaker 2 [00:39:38] Because she listens. Understanding is a different thing but I, I mean listening, I mean on this sentence.



Speaker 1 [00:39:46] Yes.

Speaker 2 [00:39:50] So she pays attention to listening. She is sensitive to listening. She cares about listening. For example, if this question was asked to me, I would say 5-6. I mean, if you were asking [Partner's Name], [Partner's Name]'s answer should be 6-7 at most, not 8-9. Because I'm a bit more... You can make a comparison with that thing (laughs). If [Partner's Name] said 9, we are really screwed (Güler). Because I'm a little bit more, I'm multifunctional, I can be in listening mode when I'm doing two or three things at the same time, but [Partner's Name] stops what she's doing and listens.

Speaker 1 [00:40:38] Can you give 1-2 concrete examples of when it happens?

Speaker 2 [00:40:42] Say it again.

Speaker 1 [00:40:43] Can you give one concrete example of how it happens, when it happens, this resting state, him listening to you? Has it happened recently?

Speaker 2 [00:40:57] It has happened a lot, well... What did we eat in the morning? What did we talk about for breakfast in the morning? Uh... No, I can't give them right now.

Speaker 1 [00:41:07] Okay. So if I ask you a question like: 'My partner is usually sensitive to my needs', how would you answer with 1 being not at all true and 9 being completely true?

Speaker 2 [00:41:28] Uh... Well, the score is high but not 9. Uh, probably 8. 7.5-8.

Speaker 1 [00:41:48] Why 7.5-8 and not 7 or 9?

Speaker 2 [00:41:53] because they have their own priorities. So because of their own priorities they can uh, do something. I mean, in the end, I mean, in case of conflicting priorities, her priority may override my priority in some cases, but most of the time she is sensitive to my needs. Most of the time I mean eight.

Speaker 1 [00:42:20] Is it possible to give a concrete example of this?

Speaker 2 [00:42:24] No. I can't think of an example right now.

Speaker 1 [00:42:29] If you don't mind, I have a couple of questions about your sex life.

Speaker 2 [00:42:34] Uh-huh, no.

Speaker 1 [00:42:36] Thank you. How often do you have sexual intercourse these days?

Speaker 2 [00:42:45] Uh, well, [1-5] times a week I guess, I would say on average.

Speaker 1 [00:42:53] How satisfied are you with your sexual life?

Speaker 2 [00:42:57] Quite. I mean we are open to each other. We are open-minded, that's why. Communication is also important, after all, sexual life should be adorned with love, it should be beautified with love. We can easily have a conversation about that. So, for me, it is happy, happiness, happy, positive.

Speaker 1 [00:43:30] I was going to ask why you said that, but I think you answered. You said that we are open, you said that it feeds on love, you said that we also have conversations, you said that we communicate.

Speaker 2 [00:43:39] I mean, after all, it is one of the basic elements of our life. Bread, cheese, wine, sex. (Laughs) I do three of them, we do one together now.

Speaker 1 [00:43:54] I have one more question then. How satisfied are you with your relationship in general? Completely dissatisfied, very dissatisfied, somewhat dissatisfied, not sure, somewhat satisfied, very satisfied, completely satisfied.

Speaker 2 [00:44:12] I mean, completely satisfied, I think it would be too much, it wouldn't be right. I'm very satisfied, definitely, if there was somewhere between very satisfied and completely

satisfied, I would say that because completely satisfied is very assertive. So I can't say that. I mean, I am completely satisfied, but I would definitely say I am very satisfied. I would say it is above very satisfied. So there might be something I missed in between. When I say I am completely satisfied, it may be ignoring some things that I don't know, that I am not aware of. I am not saying it for that, but I am more than very satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:44:57] Considering such a situation, we have another question like this. If you give me a score from 0 to 10, from not satisfied at all to completely satisfied.

Speaker 2 [00:45:07] 9, of course then it comes to 9. It goes parallel to the previous one.

Speaker 1 [00:45:20] Why 9? Why not 8? Because you explained why not 10.

Speaker 2 [00:45:25] Yes. I mean, it should be close to 10, that's why it's not 8, because I know it's above 9. Because it's not 10, it's 9. There should be something around 10, but I can't say 10 because of the elements in between that I don't know, that I'm not aware of or haven't experienced. I'm not curious.

Speaker 1 [00:45:56] Can we say that your relationship meets your expectations?

Speaker 2 [00:46:01] Yes, our relationship meets my expectations very much.

Speaker 1 [00:46:06] Okay. I have no more questions.

Speaker 2 [00:46:10] Oh, that's good. And for you. Sorry, I don't know if you're tired.(Laughs)

Speaker 1 [00:46:16] (Laughs.) Good for you too. Thank you for participating. How was it for you to be a part of this meeting?

Speaker 2 [00:46:24] Well, it's interesting because we talk about a lot of things but these are things we don't talk about in mutual communication. When [Name] asked me if I would participate, I said it was scary, I texted. Let me see what I wrote, when [Name] texted on Whatsapp. I forgot I said

something there too. She asked me why it was scary. Wait a minute what did I say... Uh, I said I was afraid of facing myself.

Speaker 1 [00:47:06] Hmm...How is it when you do it?

Speaker 2 [00:47:12] Yes, it was very good. Very well, I'm happy to face it.

Speaker 1 [00:47:17] I'm glad to hear it.

Speaker 2 [00:47:18] Thank you.

Speaker 1 [00:47:20] I would like to go over what we talked about in a short summary. If there is anything missing, if you want to add something, to give you the opportunity to correct me if I misunderstood something. You are [56-60] years old. You have been together [26-30] years. You have a daughter. You live with your husband. You are retired. You met through mutual friends in [City] and quickly made the journey from acquaintance to marriage. You guess that this is due to your frankness, the mutual trust and liking you have developed. You talked about how you are compared to your friends, that you are certainly no worse in terms of how your relationship is, that you are much better in your current environment than in the environment in your summer cottage, that you are above average if we talk about your [City] environment, that you attribute the main reason why it is not better to yourself, that you attribute your own rigidities, your own unrefined parts, to the difficulties in moving the relationship to a better place. You mentioned that you solved these difficulties by being self-critical, by continuing to talk, by not closing the communication, by trying to be open. You mentioned that you don't fight, but we can say that you fight once a month or once a year, but you engage in verbal duels once a week. We talked about the fact that you had two relationships before, but neither of them can be compared to the current one, so we can't compare them. We talked about the fact that they were more likeable, need fulfilling things rather than love. When we started talking about what makes a relationship good, when we started talking about what makes it high quality, we talked about trust, love and sharing. You defined love as communication, goodwill, understanding. We talked about the absence of love is enough to make a relationship bad, but we are talking about love as you define love.

Speaker 2 [00:49:36] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:49:42] So when we started talking about the most important things, we talked about the beauty of sharing in a relationship, we talked about the beauty of sharing, we talked about what it means to share, we talked about the pleasure of sharing, we talked about the satisfaction of making the other person happy, we talked about selflessness, we talked about supporting the

other person, standing behind the other person, helping the other person to enrich their life in a sense. We talked about how important it is to have a common opinion. We talked about how it is very important for a relationship to have a similar worldview, socioecological, socioeconomic view and stance in a common sociology. Then we talked a little bit about love. We defined love. You defined love as caring, caring, mitigating, making sacrifices, bearing the burdens of the other party, and in these contexts you differentiated it from love.

Speaker 2 [00:50:42] Uh-huh.

Speaker 1 [00:50:44] On the question of how do you know when you're loved, we talked about that it's, uh, it's a look, it's an expression, it's a hand gesture, it's not something that's visible, it's something that you feel underneath, even when you're talking about negative things, it's electric, it's warm, it doesn't throb, it makes you want more. We talked about how the relationship was definitely good for you, that you were happy, that you didn't have many goals and you didn't feel the need to replace them, that you were happy to live life as it was, that Mrs. [Partner's Name] contributed to this, that her presence was enough. When asked how you changed, we talked about how she softened your rigidities, your contradictions, how you were sculpted, how you stretched your boundaries and became more comfortable with stretching. We talked about how she was more organized, more sensitive, how she shaped her habits with you in mind. You said that you felt safe in your relationship. We talked about the fact that your communication is good, that there is no suspicion, no suspicion, nothing going on behind your back, that you feel comfortable, that you are predictable, that the habits you have developed together make life predictable. After that, we talked about questions.

Speaker 2 [00:52:24] Uh-huh.

Speaker 1 [00:52:27] Is there anything you want to add?

Speaker 2 [00:52:29] No, thank you very much. You summarized it very well, thank you. Well, it was a good summary for me too. Well, it came to me as a piece of information as well as what I said to myself.

Speaker 1 [00:52:40] I am glad.

Speaker 2 [00:52:41] Thank you.

Speaker 1 [00:52:42] Thank you for participating.

Speaker 2 [00:52:44] Thank you.

Speaker 1 [00:52:45] One last topic, we actually have two topics. The first one is how the data will be used, how the data we collect now will be used. We want to be as transparent and open about this as possible so that we fulfill our ethical duties, actually. There are three options. One is to say, I don't want this data to be used in any way. You can say that at any time. You don't have to say it right now. Two months later, three months later, if you say I don't want this data to be used any further, we will withdraw your data from anywhere we use it. This is your right at all times, and throughout the coming process. This video that I am recording now will not be shared in any way, I will keep it with me, it stays on my computer. And I will encrypt them, after things are over, after the interviews are over. Only, there is a gentleman named [Name] who is in charge of this research. They need to have a (unintelligible) transcript of the videos. In other words, these voices need to be transcribed. And since transcribing is a very laborious task, they got a program that does this. I have shared the sound to put it into that program, I will share it, if it is ok for you. Our options are as follows; we will be de-identifying this transcript in every way. We will be de-identifying it from names, age, occupation, any information that can easily identify the person, but we will not be de-identifying it from the fact that you like [name] for example.

Speaker 2 [00:54:30] What about the name, as long as it's not a name, it's fine.

Speaker 1 [00:54:33] There will be no name.

Speaker 2 [00:54:35] The name, I mean...As long as it's anonymous...It doesn't even matter if it's anonymous, I mean, it doesn't matter if it's a name. I mean, I don't care, I prefer that this information is shared with the name [Name] (unintelligible) but not.

Speaker 1 [00:54:46] No, it will be anonymous. It will definitely be anonymous. We can share some parts of this transcript. Some parts of it...

Speaker 2 [00:54:54] You can share them all. It's fine with me.

Speaker 1 [00:54:56] My second question, that was the option. Thank you very much for choosing that. Uh... Heh, before we close, in order for us to find more participants, is it possible for you to

suggest someone who can suggest us a participant? So we will not be having an interview with the person you suggest. So we will not be interviewing someone from your close circle. We will be using them as a stepping stone. So we will be using them as a stepping stone. I would like to ask if it is possible for you to suggest two such people.

Speaker 2 [00:55:33] I need permission. Well, if...

Speaker 1 [00:55:35] Of course.

Speaker 2 [00:55:36] If I get permission, I'll write it on Whatsapp.

Speaker 1 [00:55:39] Very good. I didn't expect you to suggest it now. In fact, it would be better for us to talk, for us to communicate, for me to communicate. You guys they're more likely to get back to me when I'm in contact after they've been in contact.

Speaker 2 [00:55:53] Okay. Okay.

[00:55:53]. I, well, I'll talk to the names that will come to my mind. If they approve, I will share it.

Speaker 1 [00:56:03] Thank you very much for sharing...

Speaker 2 [00:56:05] You're welcome.

Speaker 1 [00:56:05] For telling me.

Speaker 2 [00:56:06] Good luck. Godspeed.

Speaker 1 [00:56:07] Thank you.

Speaker 2 [00:56:09] Thank you, good luck. See you soon.

Speaker 1 [00:56:11] Good day. Take care of yourselves.

Speaker 2 [00:56:12] Thank you.